

Take Full Responsibility: Introduction to Modeling, Featuring Karen Hilton

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Being a leader, while deeply rewarding, is ultimately a pursuit that you have to want. As Coach Summitt said, 'If you don't want responsibility, don't sit in the big chair.' Your long-term effectiveness as a leader depends on your ability to take full responsibility.

Fail to model the behaviors of leadership that your organization values and people will follow you only because they have to, not because they want to. Miss the mark on replicating the leadership that can make your company great and you'll lose your best leaders and burn out yourself.

Modeling is doing the work, both the mundane and the significant, that you require others to do in a way that sets a standard that produces positive results people can see and feel. So, it begs the question, 'Why do we model?'

In a 21st century environment where change happens at blazing speed, isn't it just easier for busy leaders to tell people what to do? Leaders who rely on telling their teams what to do and how to act on a regular basis have sunk to a level of micromanaging.

Modeling, at its best, does two things that inspires teams both individually and collectively to become wholly committed to helping your team win.

First, modeling creates a roadmap for others to follow. It's the *how* behind the *what*.

Second, modeling reinforces credibility and trust in the eyes of those you lead. You're doing what you've asked others to do. Pat Summitt modeled the behavior she wanted to see from her staff and her players for her entire career.

In the early days, Pat had no choice but to set the example as she drove the team bus, taped ankles, and washed jerseys. But even after the Lady Vols experienced tremendous success and Pat had access to many more resources, she still modeled the behavior she wanted to see.

Now (that) we know what we mean by modeling full responsibility and why we do it, let's shift and talk about how to model full responsibility.